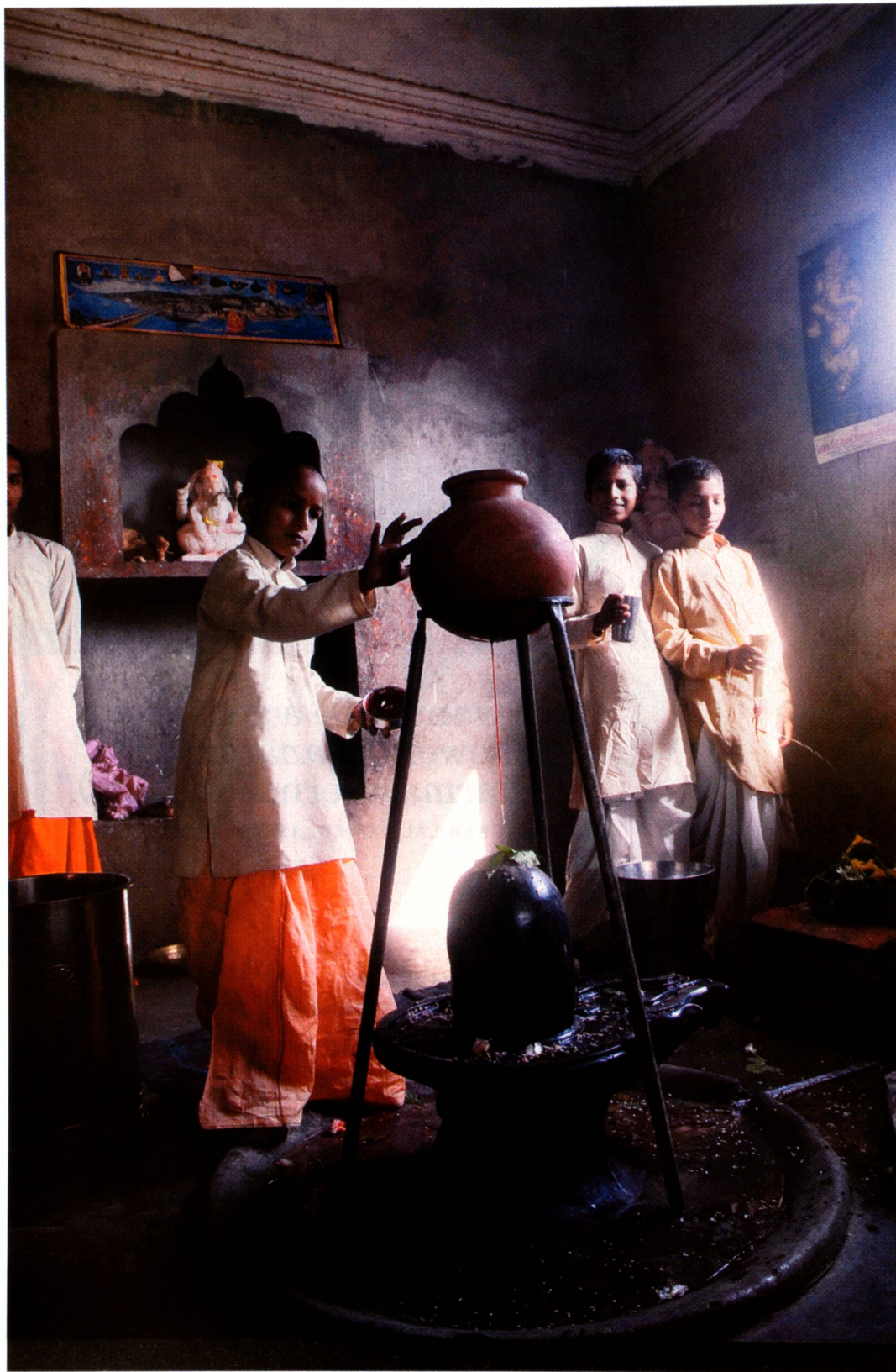




GRUELLING DAY: One of the more demanding daily rituals is *rudra abhishek*, in which a shivlinga is bathed with milk and offered flowers by disciples for two hours. This is followed by classes that last for six hours, during which students chant mantras and hymns, and are taught how to perform several rites like *vivah* and *katha*.

During their stay, boys begin to gradually internalise the belief that Brahmins are the “supreme beings” of the social order.